

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 32

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1. Abstruse

Meaning: Difficult to understand; complex and obscure.

Tip to remember: Abstruse sounds like “abstract and confusing.” An abstruse idea is hard to grasp.

Sentence: The professor explained an abstruse theory in simple language.

2. Auxiliary

Meaning: Providing help or support; additional.

Tip to remember: Think of an auxiliary battery that supports the main system.

Sentence: The hospital installed an auxiliary generator for emergencies.

3. Caricature

Meaning: An exaggerated picture, description, or imitation of someone.

Tip to remember: Think of a cartoon drawing with an oversized nose or face. That is a caricature.

Sentence: The newspaper published a caricature of the politician.

4. Depravity

Meaning: Moral corruption or wickedness.

Tip to remember: Depravity sounds like “depraved,” meaning morally bad.

Sentence: The scandal revealed the depravity of the corrupt officials.

5. Dilettante

Meaning: A person who takes interest in an art or subject without serious knowledge or commitment.

Tip to remember: Think of someone who tries painting, music, and coding only for show, never deeply. That person is a dilettante.

Sentence: He spoke like an expert, but he was only a dilettante in philosophy.

6. Effrontery

Meaning: Shameless boldness or rude confidence.

Tip to remember: Think of someone insulting a teacher in front of the whole class. That shameless nerve is effrontery.

Sentence: He had the effrontery to blame others for his own mistake.

7. **Encroach**
Meaning: To gradually enter or take over someone else's space, rights, or territory.
Tip to remember: Encroach sounds like "crawl in." Something encroaches when it slowly moves into another area.
Sentence: New buildings began to encroach on the farmland.
8. **Endow**
Meaning: To provide with a gift, quality, money, or ability.
Tip to remember: Think of a donor giving money to a university. The donor endows it.
Sentence: The scholarship was endowed by a former student.
9. **Entreat**
Meaning: To ask someone earnestly or desperately.
Tip to remember: Entreat sounds like "entry treat." Imagine begging for entry politely.
Sentence: The villagers entreated the mayor to repair the road.
10. **Gregarious**
Meaning: Sociable and enjoying the company of others.
Tip to remember: Think of someone who loves groups and gatherings. That person is gregarious.
Sentence: His gregarious nature helped him make friends quickly.
11. **Indictment**
Meaning: A formal accusation of wrongdoing; also, a strong sign that something is wrong.
Tip to remember: Indictment sounds like "in-dict court." It is a formal charge in court.
Sentence: The report was an indictment of the company's poor safety culture.
12. **Indignant**
Meaning: Angry because something is unfair or wrong.
Tip to remember: Think of anger with dignity. If your dignity is hurt unfairly, you feel indignant.
Sentence: She was indignant when falsely accused of cheating.
13. **Ineluctable**
Meaning: Impossible to avoid or escape.
Tip to remember: Ineluctable sounds like "cannot elect out." You cannot choose to escape it.
Sentence: Change is an ineluctable part of life.
14. **Inquisitive**
Meaning: Curious and eager to ask questions.
Tip to remember: Inquisitive comes from inquiry. An inquisitive person keeps inquiring.
Sentence: The inquisitive student asked many thoughtful questions.

15. **Latitude**
Meaning: Freedom to act or make choices; also, distance north or south of the equator.
Tip to remember: GRE trick: latitude often means freedom or flexibility.
Sentence: The professor gave students latitude in choosing their research topics.
16. **Levity**
Meaning: Lightness or humor, especially in a serious situation.
Tip to remember: Levity sounds like “levitate,” meaning become light. Levity makes a serious mood lighter.
Sentence: A little levity helped reduce the tension in the room.
17. **Malevolent**
Meaning: Wishing harm or evil to others.
Tip to remember: “Mal” means bad, and “volent” relates to wishing. Malevolent means wishing bad.
Sentence: The villain had a malevolent plan to destroy the city.
18. **Mediate**
Meaning: To help settle a dispute between two sides.
Tip to remember: Mediate contains “middle.” A mediator stands in the middle and helps both sides agree.
Sentence: The teacher mediated the disagreement between the students.
19. **Occlude**
Meaning: To block, close, or obstruct.
Tip to remember: Occlude sounds like “close.” To occlude something is to close or block it.
Sentence: Clouds occluded the view of the mountain peak.
20. **Pacify**
Meaning: To calm someone down or restore peace.
Tip to remember: Pacify sounds like pacific, which means peaceful.
Sentence: The manager tried to pacify the angry customers.
21. **Paragon**
Meaning: A perfect example of a quality.
Tip to remember: Think of a person who is the perfect model of honesty or courage. That person is a paragon.
Sentence: She is a paragon of discipline and hard work.
22. **Patronize**
Meaning: To treat someone as inferior; also, to support a business or artist.
Tip to remember: GRE trick: patronize can mean support, but often means speaking down to someone.
Sentence: The senior student tried to help without sounding patronizing.
23. **Penurious**
Meaning: Extremely poor; or extremely unwilling to spend money.

Tip to remember: Penurious sounds like “penny.” A penurious person has few pennies or refuses to spend them.

Sentence: The penurious man refused to donate even a small amount.

24. **Piquant**

Meaning: Pleasantly sharp, spicy, or interesting.

Tip to remember: Think of spicy achar that wakes up your taste buds. That taste is piquant.

Sentence: The story had a piquant detail that made it memorable.

25. **Rampant**

Meaning: Spreading widely and uncontrollably.

Tip to remember: Think of weeds growing everywhere without control. They are rampant.

Sentence: Rumors became rampant after the announcement.

26. **Remote**

Meaning: Far away; unlikely; distant in manner.

Tip to remember: A remote village is far away; a remote chance is also far from happening.

Sentence: There is only a remote possibility that the exam will be postponed.

27. **Reprobate**

Meaning: An immoral or wicked person.

Tip to remember: Reprobate sounds like “rejected by good society.” A reprobate behaves badly.

Sentence: The novel’s villain is a selfish reprobate.

28. **Turbid**

Meaning: Muddy, cloudy, or unclear.

Tip to remember: Think of dirty floodwater. It is turbid because you cannot see through it.

Sentence: The river became turbid after the heavy rain.

29. **Turgid**

Meaning: Swollen; overly complicated or pompous in language.

Tip to remember: Turgid sounds like “too rigid and swollen.” Turgid writing is inflated and hard to read.

Sentence: The article’s turgid style made a simple idea difficult to understand.

30. **Vacuous**

Meaning: Empty, silly, or lacking thought.

Tip to remember: Vacuous sounds like vacuum. A vacuous statement is empty like a vacuum.

Sentence: The speech was full of vacuous promises.